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General Comment

Copyright has been a fixture of creative work for well over a century. It is the legal structure that allows creativity to pay. A classroom teacher cannot photocopy a short story to teach a class; a community theater must purchase the rights to perform a play. Cover artists have to pay the writer to use the song. Libraries pay for copies of books to lend, and for many authors and smaller music makers, are a major source of royalties. If we do not allow the most community-minded, altruistic uses of our work without our permission, even when we waive our fees, why would we permit corporations that literally waste billions of dollars, gigawatts of electricity, and acre-feet of water in the pursuit of a nonsense generator less effective than any random barfly on \$5 pitcher night? They're well funded; 5 billion dollars could easily buy legitimate library copies of almost all of our collective works.

LLMs are not children. They do not learn, they are fed massive amounts of data and play with statistical dice to yack out the next statistically likely word in sequence. So the analogy of the LLM reads the whole library is self-serving theft.

LLM/GenAI's desire to steal work from people who are already poorly paid is so Dickensian that even a Manchester cotton baron or US rail baron would blush at the outright theft they want the government to bless for them.

There is no amount of data that will make LLMs work even at the level of intern. They're a pipe dream and an expression of a religious ideation created by such poorly educated tech bros that they don't even recognize a Pascal's Wager when it smacks them in the face. To allow them to steal any piece of written work in their quixotic quest for a machine that wishes to kill everyone who didn't help it be born is to play to the worst fantasies of an over-specialized group of nerds in desperate need of the humanities.